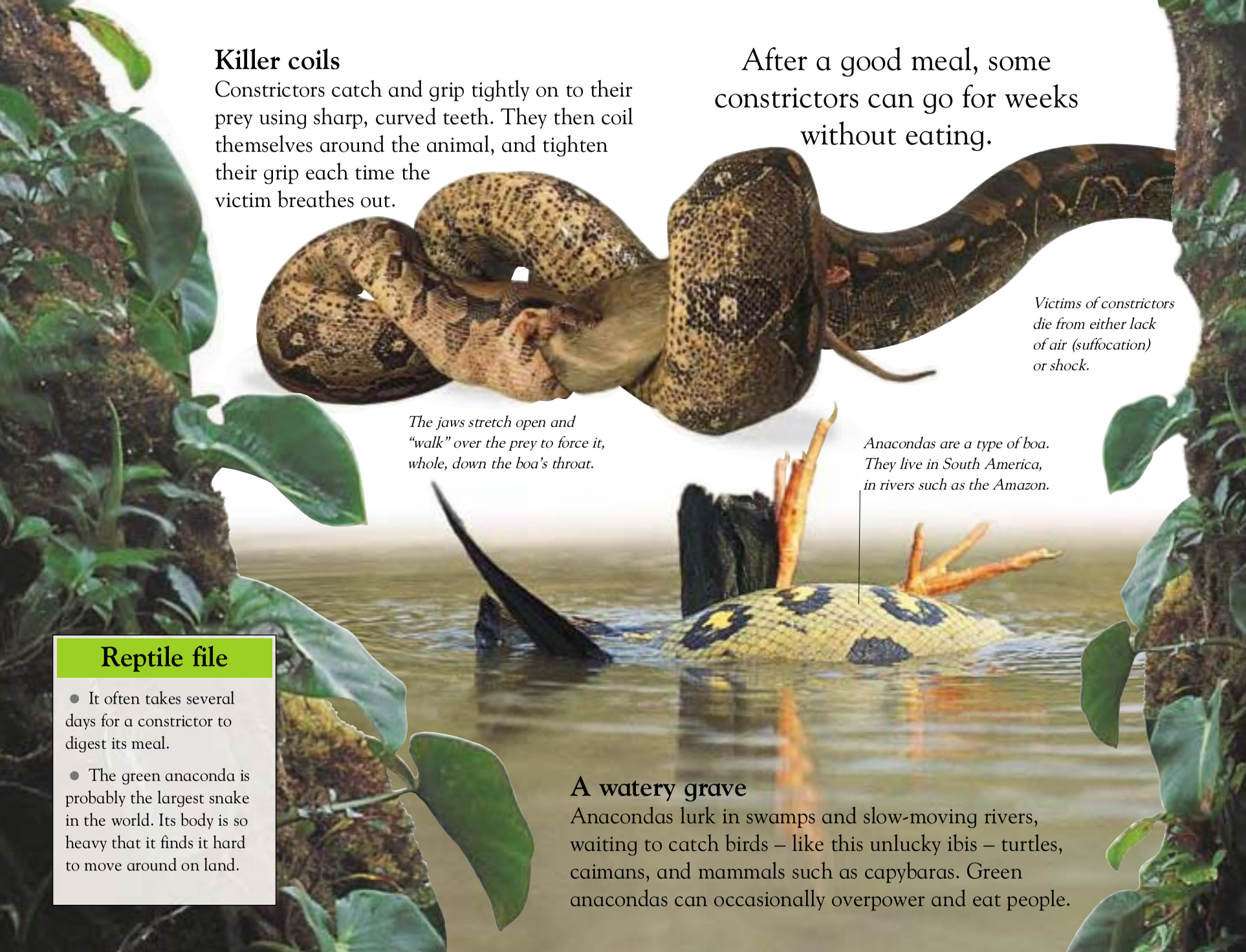
Killer coils

Constrictors catch and grip tightly on to their prey using sharp, curved teeth. They then coil themselves around the animal, and tighten their grip each time the victim breathes out.

After a good meal, some constrictors can go for weeks without eating.



Victims of constrictors die from either lack of air (suffocation) or shock.

The jaws stretch open and "walk" over the prey to force it, whole, down the boa's throat.

Anacondas are a type of boa. They live in South America, in rivers such as the Amazon.

Reptile file

- It often takes several days for a constrictor to digest its meal.
- The green anaconda is probably the largest snake in the world. Its body is so heavy that it finds it hard to move around on land.

A watery grave

Anacondas lurk in swamps and slow-moving rivers, waiting to catch birds – like this unlucky ibis – turtles, caimans, and mammals such as capybaras. Green anacondas can occasionally overpower and eat people.